



Industrious Final Report

*Research
Methods*

Creating Natural, Authentic connection in shared workspace
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Research Goal and Purpose



How we do the Research



Insights



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“Believe it or not, there was probably *less than 10 people for that whole building that came...*
(Japanese Stitching Event)... Less than 10 people.”

– Industrious Worker

Research Goal Purpose

01. Increase the interaction between workers and the usage of shared office spaces

02. Foster stronger belonging, engagement

Goal *03.* Higher member retention at Industrious.

How Do We Research?

01

Research Planning & Preparation

- Set up research Goal
- Recruiting
- Interview questions

02

Data Collection

- Interview
- Organized participant snapshots with key quotes

03

Analysis & Synthesis

- Affinity Mapping
- Pattern Recognition
- Theme: Developed 3 core insights

04

Ideation & Recommendations

- HMW
- Solutions

We conducted interviews with 9 participants,
3 Industrious Members, 5 Office-Hybrid Workers, 1 Workplace Operations Expert

Common

- Most participants work in **hybrid**, moving fluidly between office, home, and third spaces.
- People want **awareness without interruption**—knowing who is around, without being watched or socially exposed.
- Responsiveness, clarity, and everyday **kindness** **matter more than formal bonding** or networking.
- Social connection is preferred when it is embedded into **daily routines** (coffee, lunch, brief check-ins), not scheduled events.

Expert

- Daily touchpoints (tea, coffee, greetings) outperform big events

Industrious Members

- Prefer **topic-based** or utility-driven interactions over generic social events (e.g., classes, markets tied to personal interests) — Margaret
- Shared amenities (coffee bar, cafeteria) function as natural, **low-pressure social touchpoints**, used in short, task-adjacent moments — Margaret, Intercept
- Post-COVID, large programmed events declined, replaced by small, recurring rituals (coffee, tea, seasonal moments) — Margaret, Frank

Workers

- Workers **prioritize choice, flexibility, and psychological safety** in both space and social interaction. – Christine, Jasia, Eliana
- Many **avoid events that require forced interaction** with strangers or unclear expectations (who attends, dress code, purpose). – Spencer, Eliana
- **Peer-driven interaction** feels safer and more meaningful than manager-led or top-down initiatives. – Christine, Hyukjin
- **Spatial conditions** (noise, partitions, visibility, access to quiet zones) strongly affect whether people feel open to engage or withdraw. – Sohyun, Cynthia, Jasia

Insights – Theme

01. Can I Be Myself Here

02. Control over environment and work style

03. Appreciation, Bonding & Opportunity for Shared Office Spaces

Theme 1: Can I be myself here

Insight

People hesitate to join office events not because they're unsure of the event's value, but because they're unsure if they can show up as themselves without **forced performance**.

*"I am past for the show and **trying to impress anyone** and I **don't need to put on ears**. I would rather go to a bar probably with people one or two people that I know really well when we can just be ourselves."*



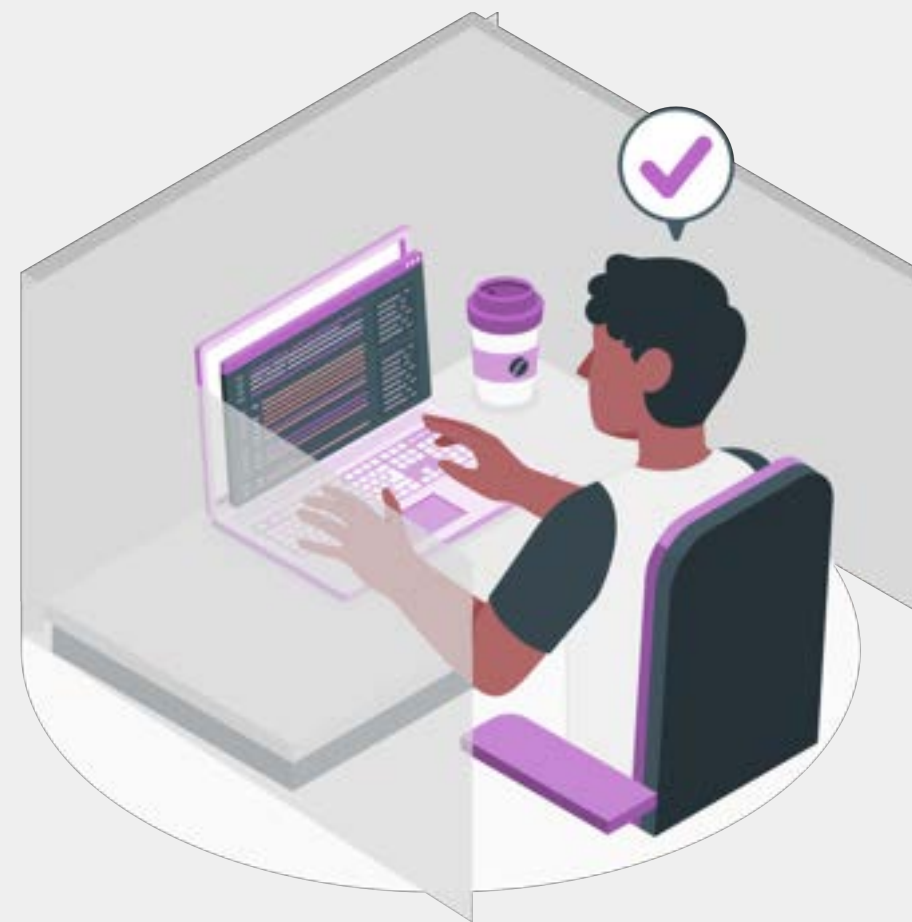
Feeling they need to
"Perform"

- Avoid feeling "performative" or act like someone else
- Avoid feeling obliged to make contextless small talk
- Prefer gathering with close, trusted individuals they know really well to be themselves

Theme 2: Control over environment and work style

Insight

Workers are not choosing between focus and collaboration; they are seeking a way to stay mentally focused while socially present—and current workplace design does not support this **in-between state**.



"So many people want different things and they interrupt"

Focus

in-between state



"It would be so much easier to just like go over and be like, Hey, can you help me with this really quick."

Collaboration

Theme 2: Control over environment and work style

Insight

Workers don't simply need different spaces for focus and collaboration. They need shared environments that communicate intent without explanation.



"I'm not sometimes I tell my co-workers if you see me wearing headphones it means my office door is shut, so don't disrupt me."
— Margaret

Focus



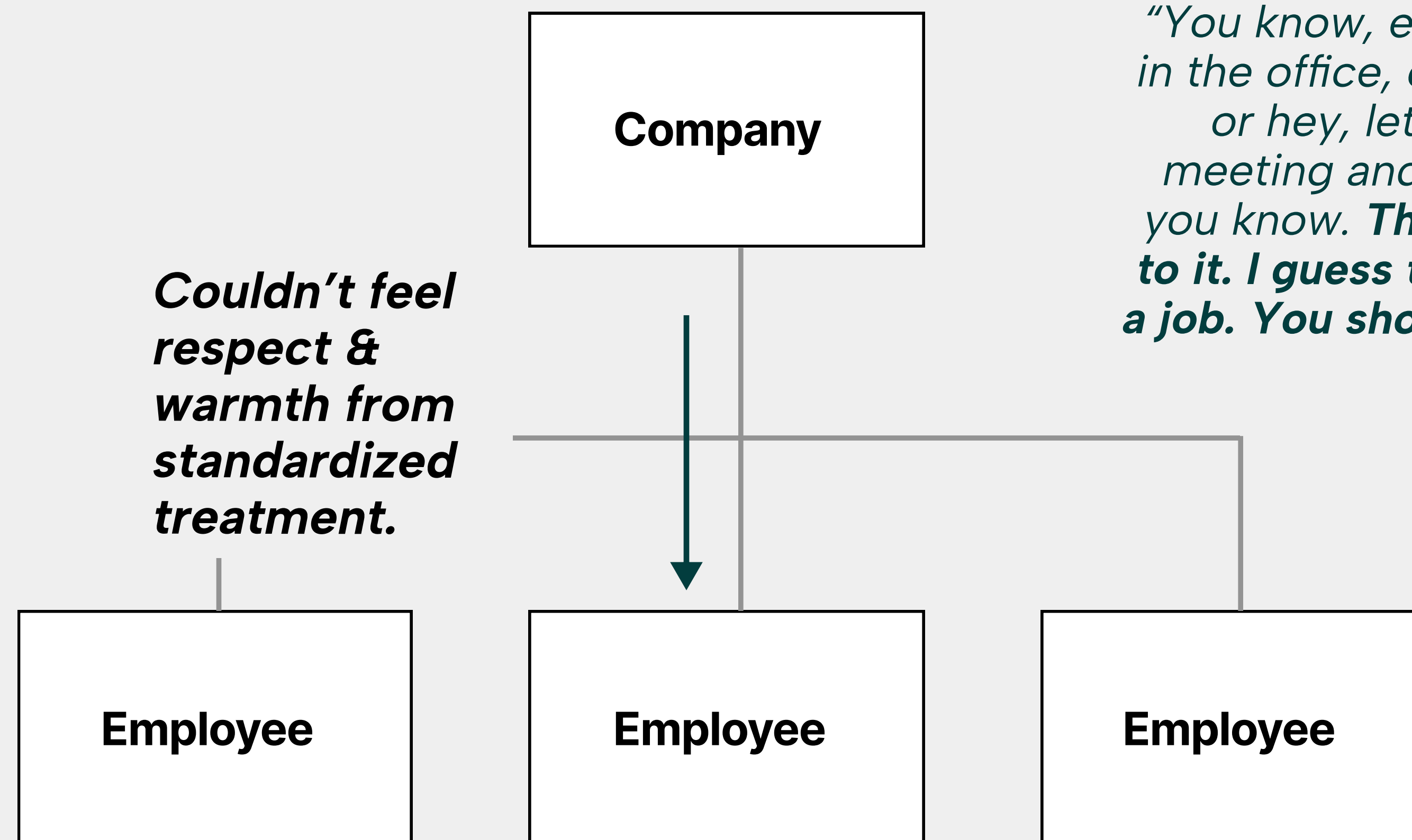
"if I'm going to have to email you anyways I might as well not come in because we're just going to be email yelling back and forth"
— Jasia

Collaboration

Theme 3: Appreciation, Bonding & Opportunity for Shared Office Spaces

Insight

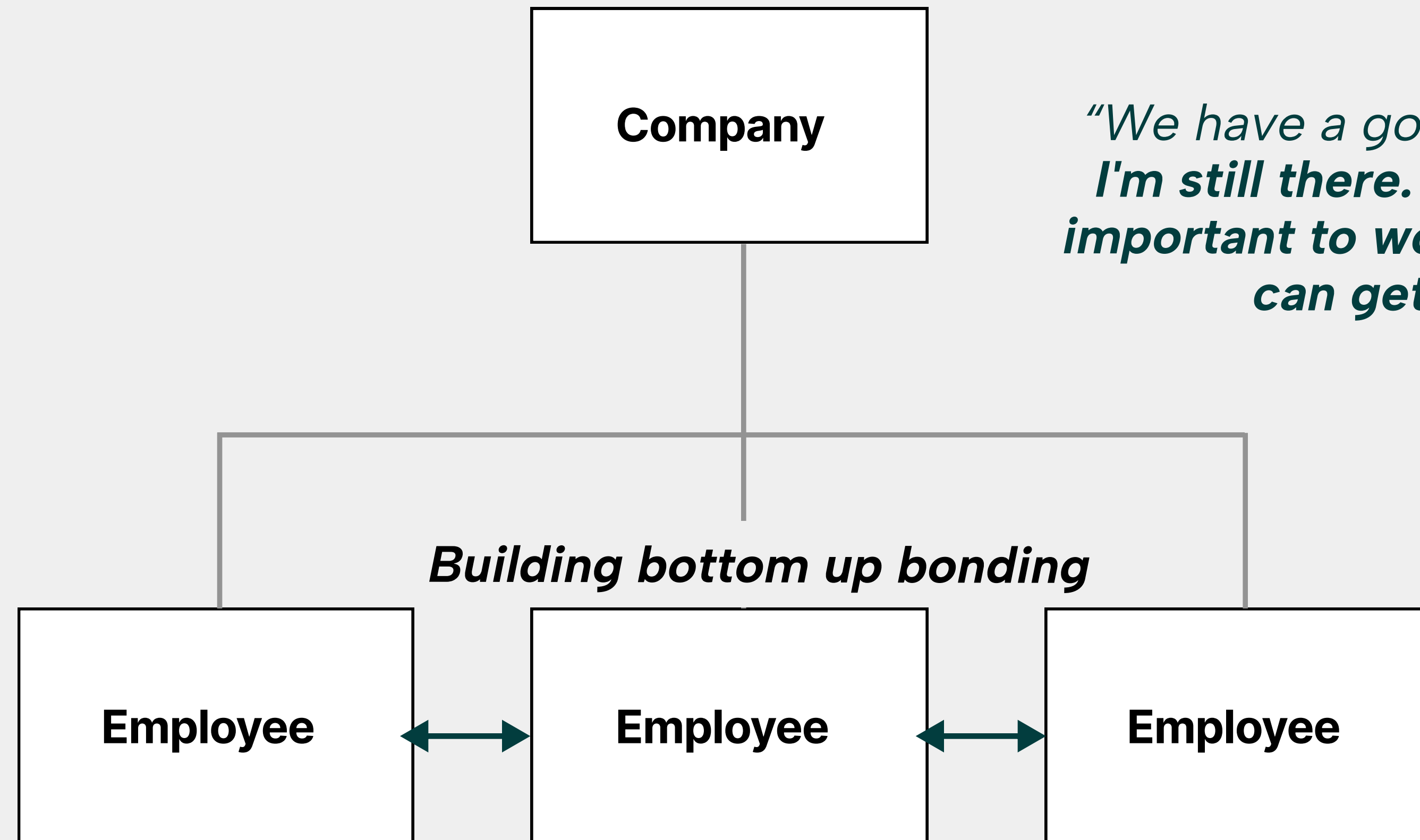
When **top-down systems fail to provide human warmth**, employees turn to bottom-up connections for fulfilment, which creates a gap that shared office spaces can bridge.



Theme 3: Appreciation, Bonding & Opportunity for Shared Office Spaces

Insight

When top-down systems fail to provide human warmth, **employees turn to bottom-up connections for fulfilment**, which creates a gap that shared office spaces can bridge.

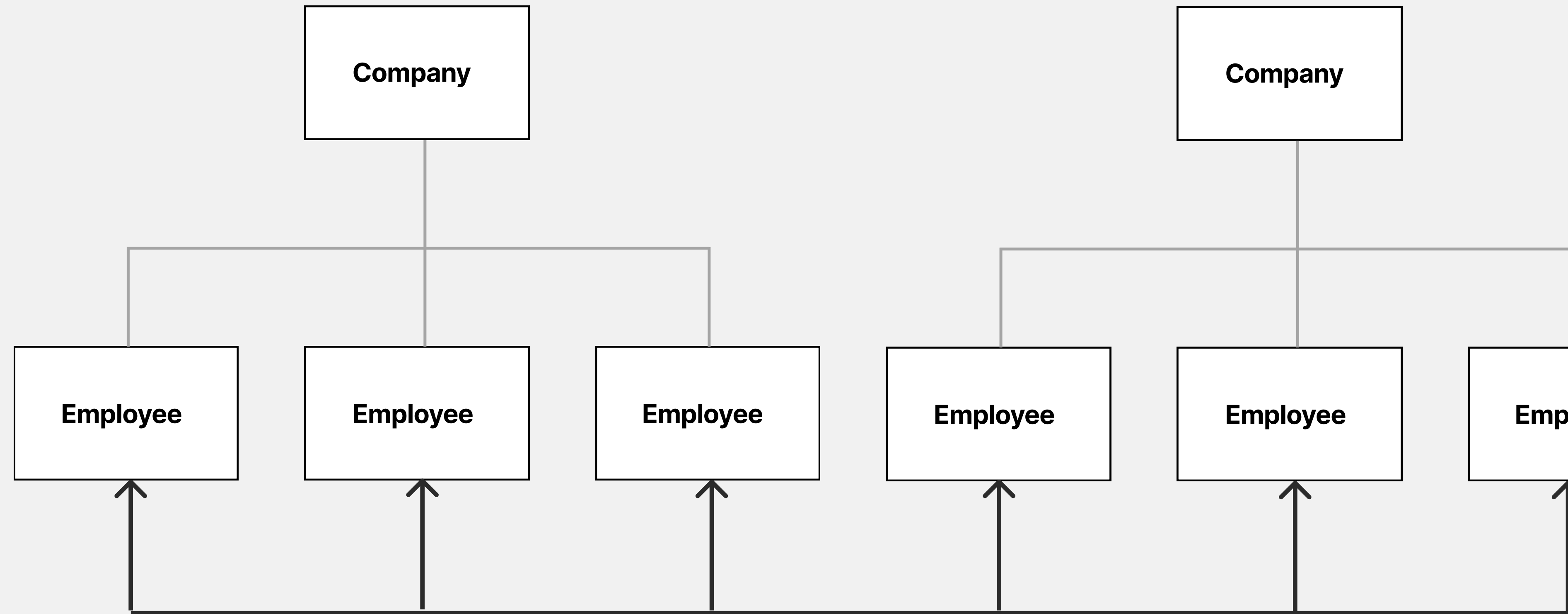


*"We have a good team. **That's why I'm still there. That's it for me. It's important to work with people that I can get along with.**"*

Theme 3: Appreciation, Bonding & Role of Shared Office Spaces

Insight

When top-down systems fail to provide human warmth, employees turn to bottom-up connections for fulfilment, which **creates a gap that shared office spaces can bridge.**



Industrious as a Bridge!

Industrious Right Now is doing so good on!

- Providing **professional/well-supported system for the workers.**
- Offering **valuable services that meet daily workplace needs.**

Design Opportunity: Facilitating Organic Connection

A better space for people to be themselves, and connect organically through:

- Create natural interaction touchpoints (not forced networking)
- Enable peer-driven community building
- Design for comfort and psychological safety
- Support warmth throughout the building"

Recommendations

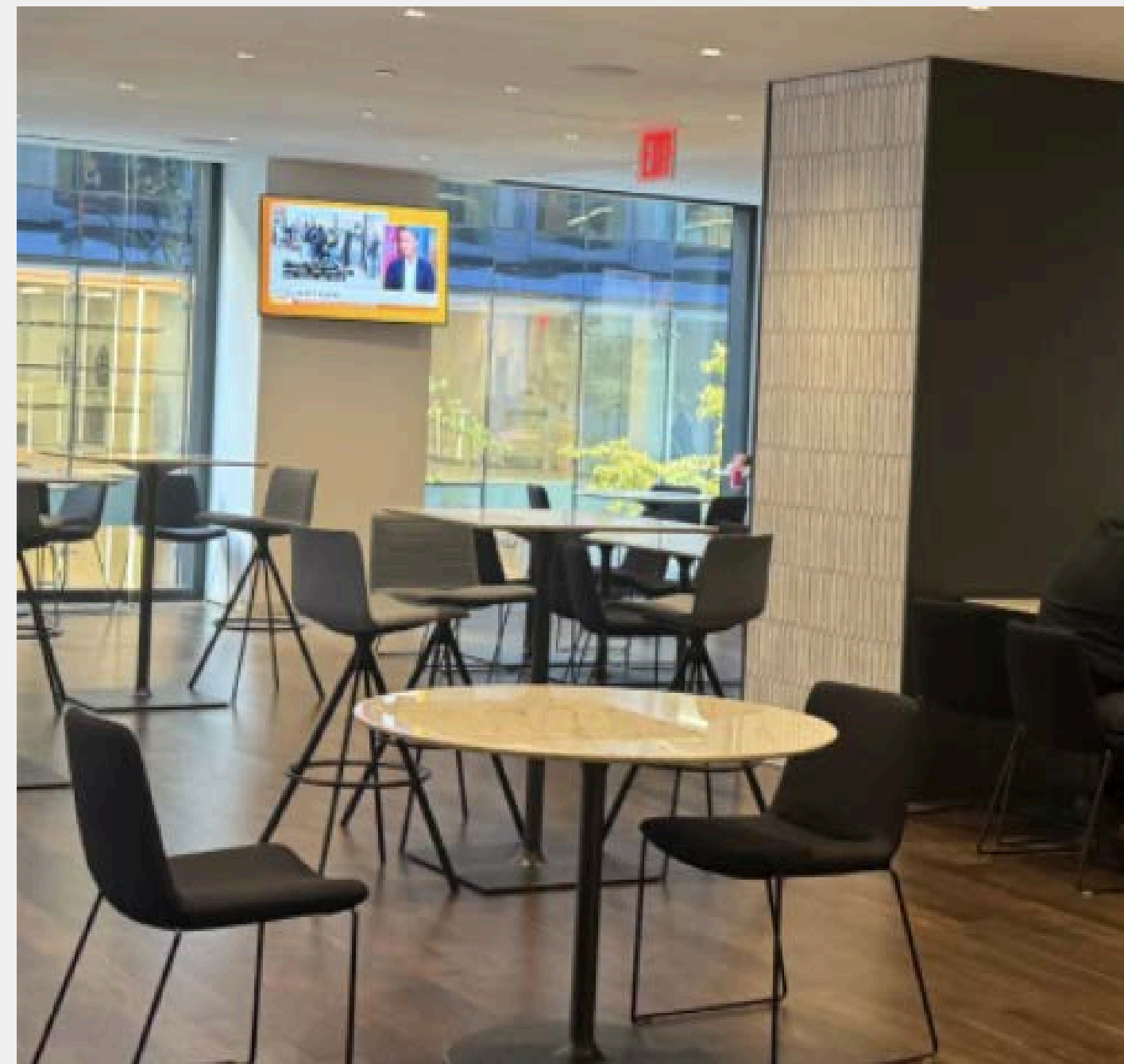
Recommendation 1

Low-stakes conversation starters

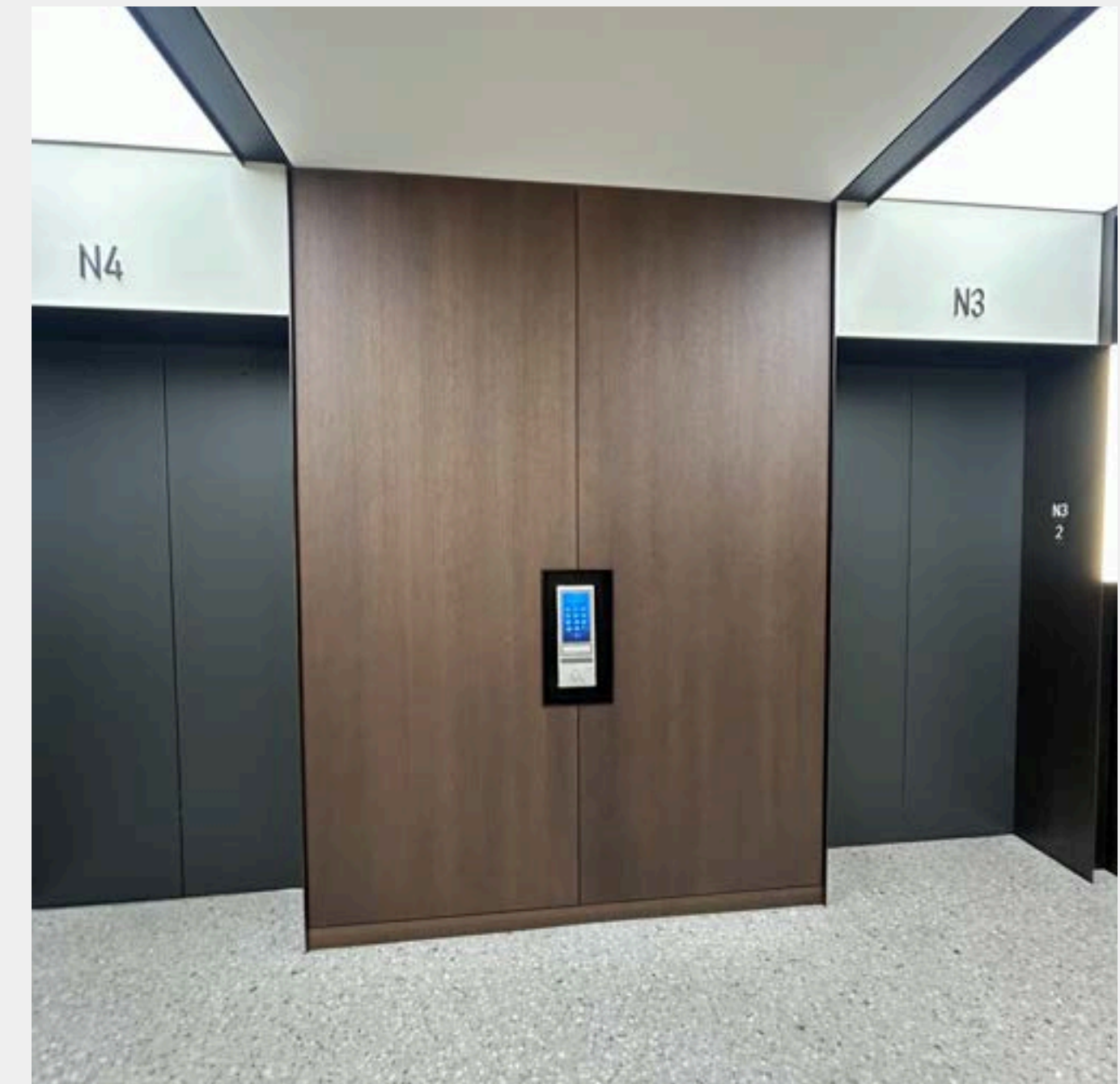
Where do people often start the small conversation? → Nice place to start!



1. Getting coffee



2. Eating



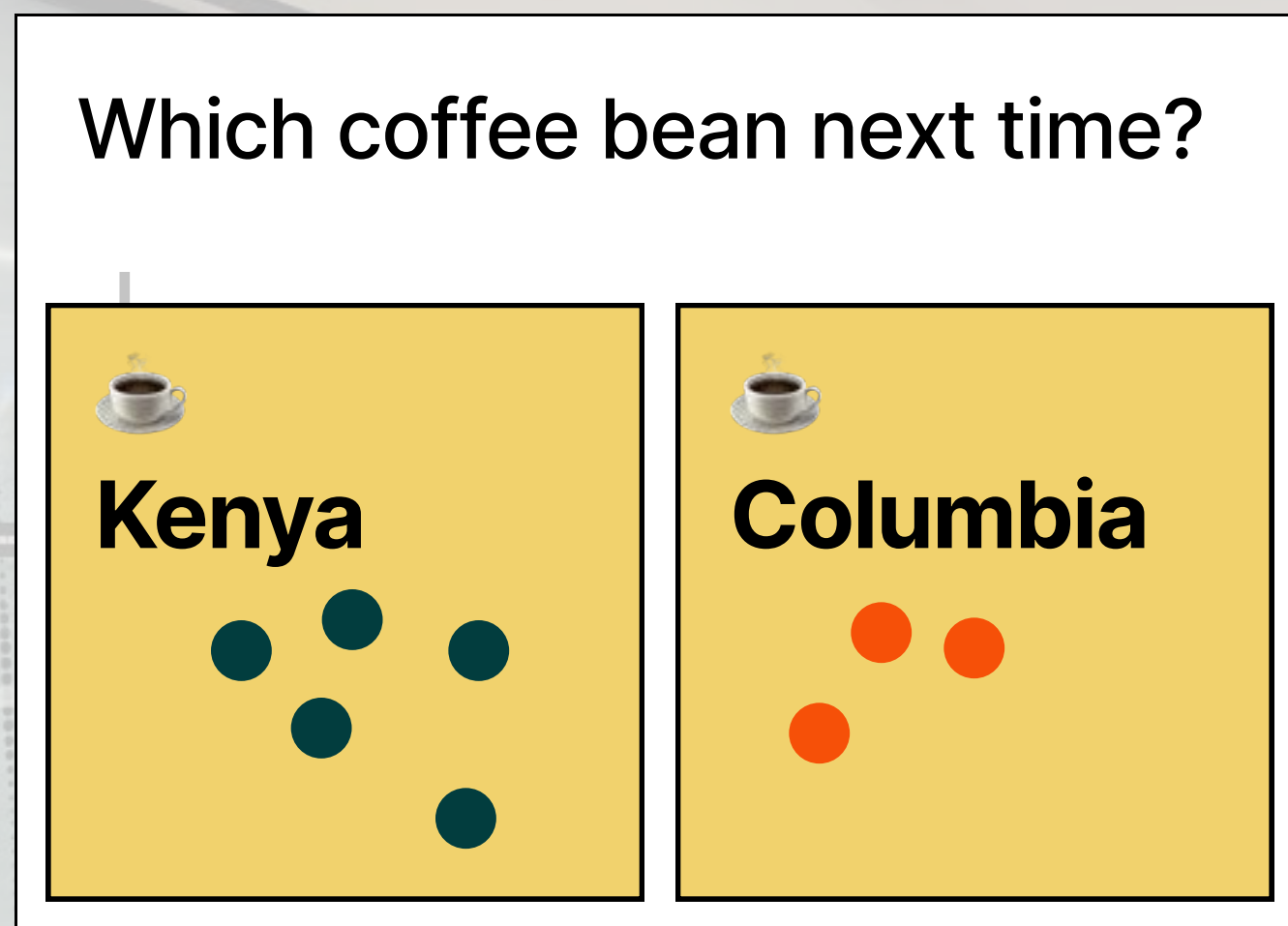
3. Waiting/ Inside elevator

Recommendation 1

Low-stakes conversation starters

Where do people often start the small conversation? → Nice place to start!

Tea / Coffee Bean Voting



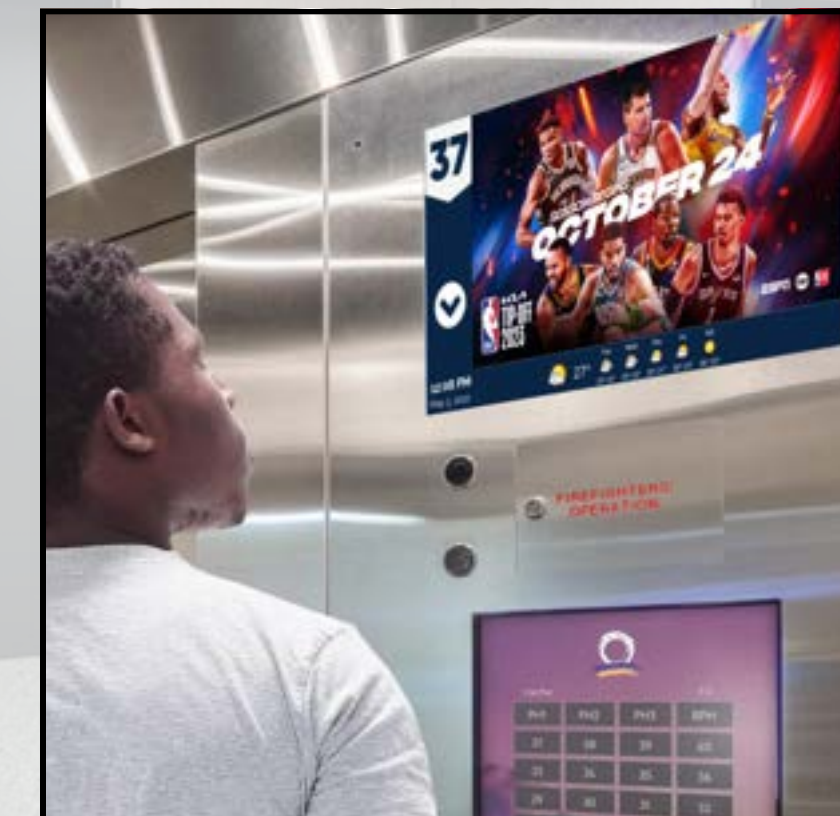
1. Getting coffee

Local Restaurant Map on the table



2. Eating

A screen showed peer driven activity.

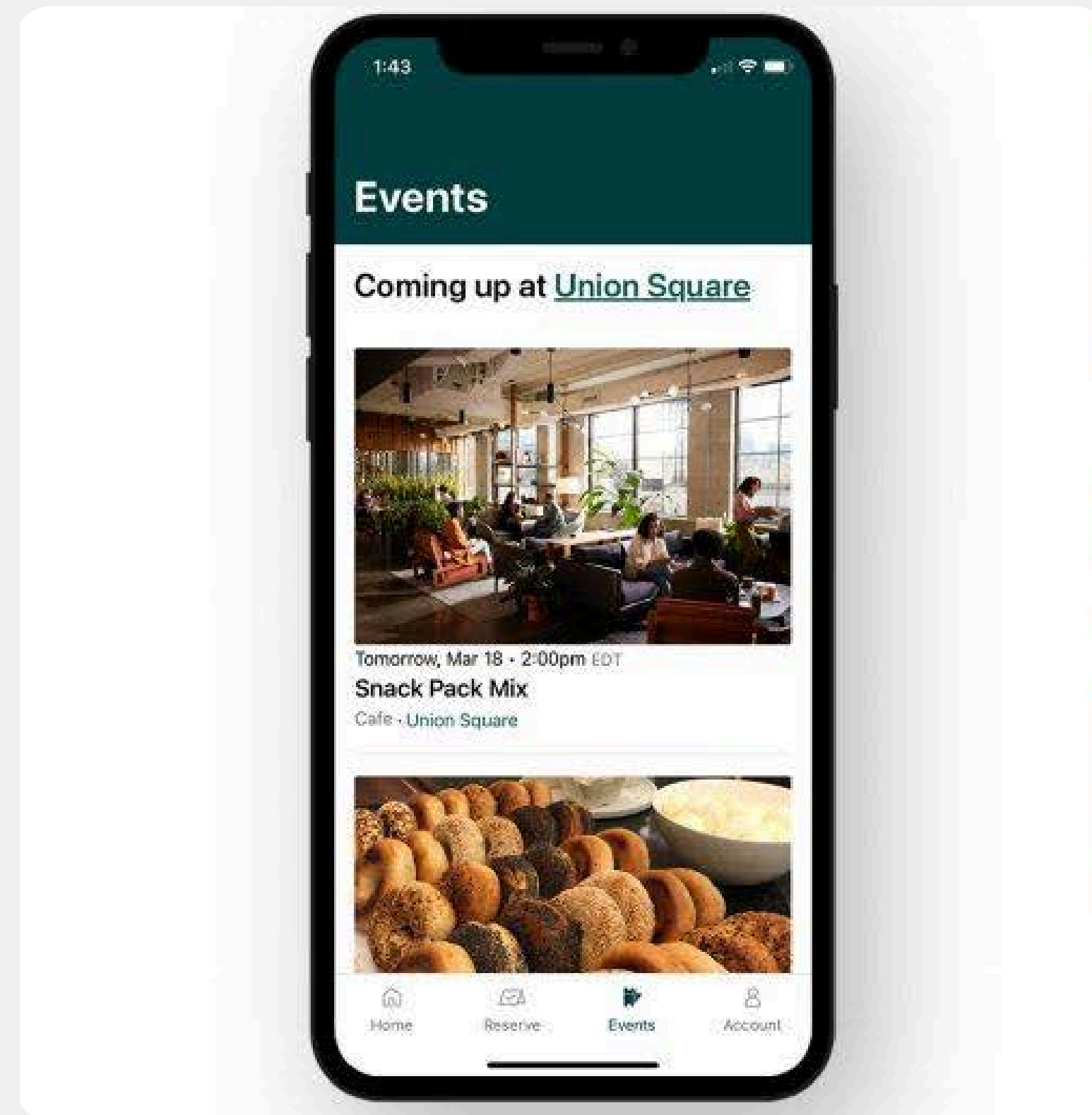


3. Waiting/ Inside elevator

Recommendation 2

App – Peer Driven Event

Current:



"I was trying to look for the breakfast menu, but I can not find anything! And they are only showing the lunch menu without pictures."

- Underutilised
- Feels very top-down – (news letter like, just sending out information)

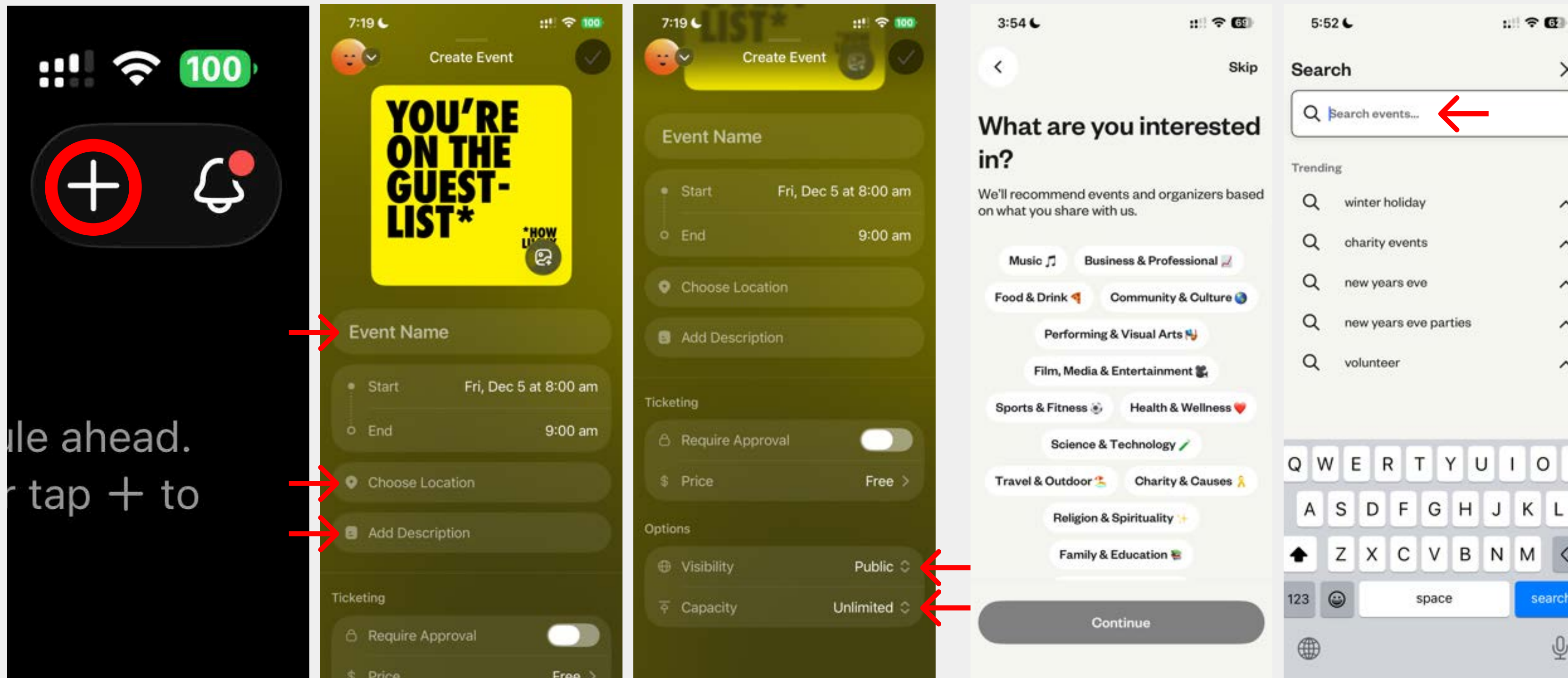
Recommendation 2

App – Peer Driven Event

Allowing workers to host their own event! → Finding people with similar interests

Example Features:

Searching Events:

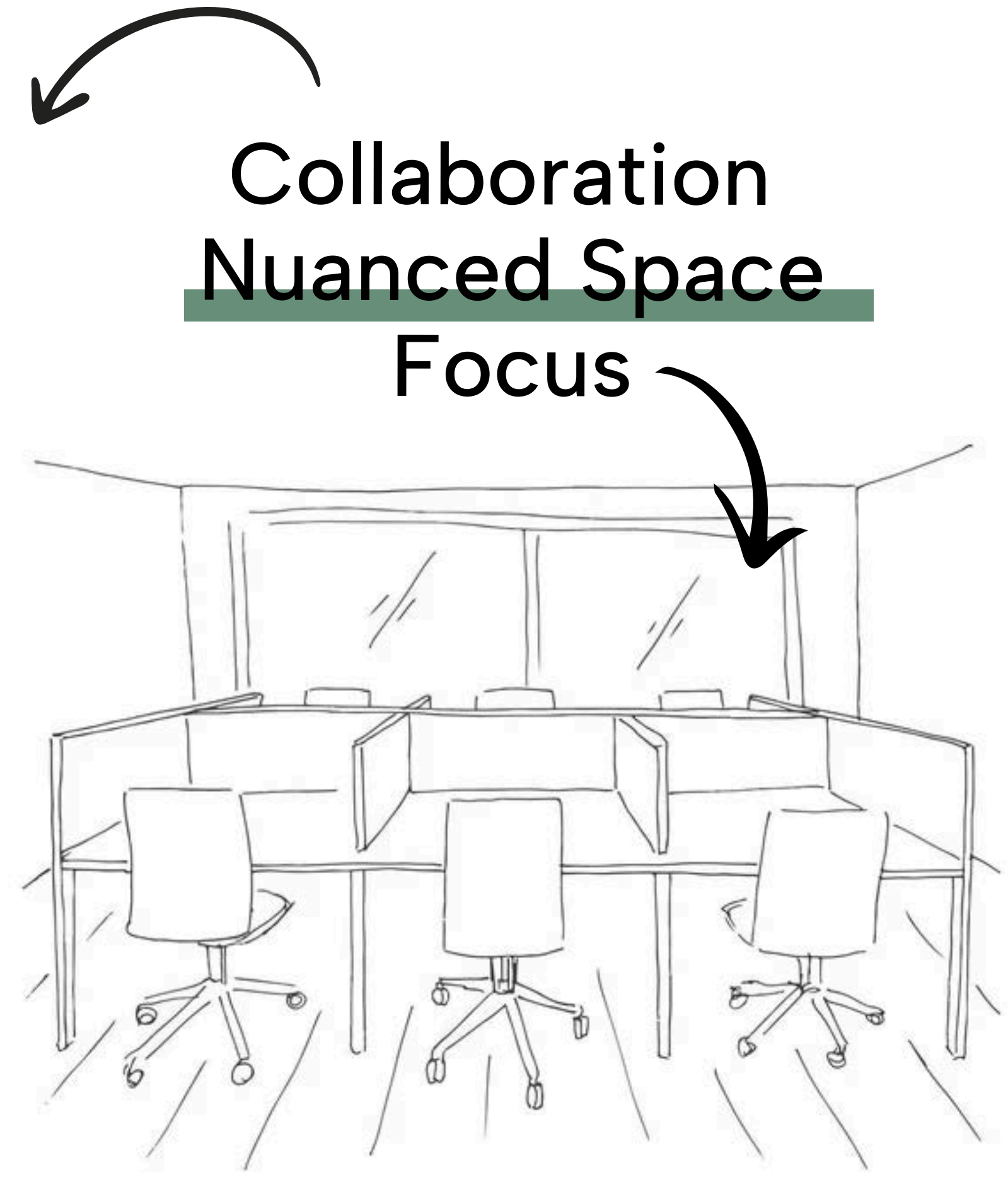


- Allowing bottom-up connections
- Allows people to be their authentic selves and showcase their own hobbies
- More connected to the broader office community, leading to increased loyalty and investment in Industrious (improving retention)

Recommendation 3

Nuanced Space

Some workers need ambient presence—the energy of people and background noise—but want to work alone without social interaction.



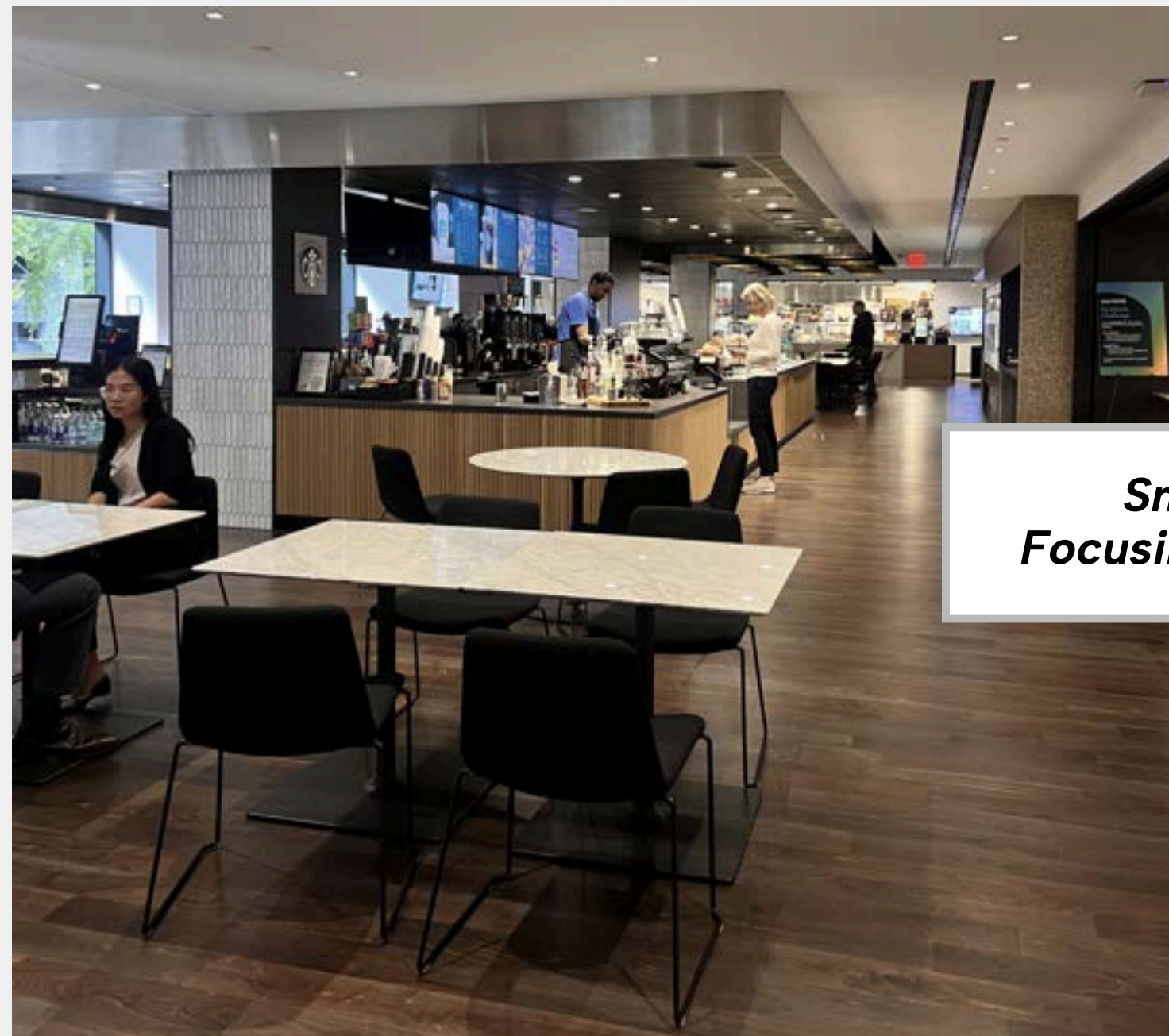
Collaboration
Nuanced Space
Focus

Recommendation 3

Nuanced Space

The dining/kitchen areas are often social collaboration spaces, but they should be rethought to allow for more flexible ways to work. This involves designing spaces that signal a worker's intention.

Designing focus-supportive micro-zones within social spaces



**Small
Focusing Zone**



"I'll go to the cafe shop, there is white noise, something to drink, and I am able to focus. There are things still happening around but it wouldn't be too distracting."







Thank You! are There
Any Questions *or Topics*
You'd Like to Discuss?